AUIB
Society of
Arts and
Letters

SAL-BRD-01 · Version 6
الهوية البصرية

Brand and *Identity*

The Society's design system, version 6: the same logo, colors and type, used with more restraint. Less ink, more page.

For the Media Director, the Design Lead and anyone making something with the Society's name on it

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WHAT CHANGED

What *changed*

Version 4 gave the Society its symbol and wordmarks; the v5 amendment set out how screens look. Version 6 keeps the logo, the AUIB colors and Ubuntu, and changes how they are used. The site felt busy because every part was turned up to full volume.

AREA	VERSION 4 AND V5	VERSION 6
Logo	Notched symbol; four-line English and Arabic wordmarks with AUIB	**Unchanged.** The symbol is named the Bookmark
Color	Nine tones, pink tint cards and panels	Six colors; crimson once or twice a page at full strength; no tints
Headlines	Ubuntu Bold, in crimson	Ubuntu Light, in ink; one italic crimson word at most
Type	Ubuntu, Ubuntu Arabic, Ubuntu Mono	**Same families.** Light and italics in use; Literata inside Qirtas
Screens (v5)	2 px frames, offset shadows, tracked-capital buttons	Hairlines and space; one solid button; sentence case
Documents	Crimson footer band and Contents band	A crimson Bookmark ribbon; hairline footer
Posts	Name, symbol, Bold crimson headline, four grounds	The lockup, a Light headline, three grounds
The paper	Waraq; “AUIB Literary Journal”	Qirtas قرطاس
Spelling	British in formal documents	American everywhere (October 8, 2026)
Mascot	—	Hudhud, the Telegram bot, with twelve stickers

Kept

The logo files, AUIB crimson, ink and white, Ubuntu and Ubuntu Arabic, the motto, the voice, the documents and their codes.

Retired

Crimson-50, ink-70, ink-50 and the “rule” gray; frames and offset shadows; Bold crimson headlines; the Waraq name.

Where it lives

The design system “AUIB Society of Arts and Letters” (v6) and the platform’s `brand/` folder.

THREE PRINCIPLES

Modern page, *old pen.*

A society about writing should look like the best-made page on campus: wide margins, light type, one crimson mark. Modern in its restraint, literary in its words, and plainly part of AUIB.

Quiet by default

White space, hairline rules and sentence case carry the page. Each page gets one loud thing: a headline, one crimson word or one band of color. If two things compete, remove one.

Two languages, one voice

English and Arabic are set in the same family, Ubuntu and Ubuntu Arabic, and placed side by side as equals. Arabic is written for Arabic readers and checked by a native speaker, never tucked underneath as a translation.

The page is the brand

The symbol is a bookmark. Everything else is built from what a book is made of: pages, margins, rules and type. No icons, no gradients, no shadows.

The paper and the *pen.*

والقرطاسُ والقلم

OUR MOTTO · AL-MUTANABBI

THE SYMBOL

The *Bookmark*

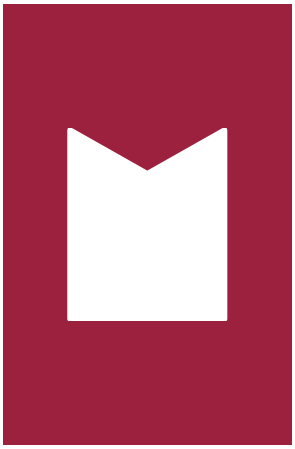
A crimson panel with a V-notch cut into its top. Turned over, it is the tail of a ribbon bookmark: the mark that keeps a reader's place. Its name is the Bookmark, in Arabic «العلامة».



sal-symbol.svg · crimson, on white or paper



sal-symbol-white.svg · on ink



sal-symbol-white.svg · on crimson



Turned over

Why a bookmark

It marks a place in a book: the Society keeps yours. It reads as a page, a ribbon and the notch of the Typewriter's paper guide.

The marker

In layouts, a 12–14 px Bookmark starts each section title, in place of boxes and colored kickers. It is a marker, never a logo: no wordmark beside it.

The rules

Crimson on white or paper; white on crimson or ink. Never crimson on ink, never outlined, rotated in use, given a gradient or a second color.

THE WORDMARKS

The *wordmarks*

The name in two languages, each on four lines, drawn once and never retyped. Unchanged from version 4.

AUIB
Society of
Arts and
Letters

جمعيةُ الفنونِ
والآدابِ في
الجامعةِ
الأمريكيةِ

sal-wordmark-en.svg · “AUIB / Society of / Arts and / Letters” in Ubuntu Bold, left-aligned

sal-wordmark-ar.svg · «جمعيةُ الفنونِ / والآدابِ في / الجامعةِ / الأمريكيةِ» in Ubuntu Arabic Bold, right-aligned





Color is one hue: **crimson-700** wordmarks on light grounds; **crimson-100** on crimson and ink (the reversed files).

Text is outlined in the files, so no fonts are needed. Line breaks, spacing and proportions are fixed.

Below about 9 px cap height the four lines stop being legible: use the Bookmark alone.

Never set the wordmark in ink, retype it, re-break its lines or set it on one line.

LOCKUPS

Lockups

The symbol and the wordmarks, arranged three ways, each in a light and a reversed file. The logo appears once per page or post.



Horizontal · the default: headers, covers, letterheads, posts



Horizontal, reversed · on ink and crimson



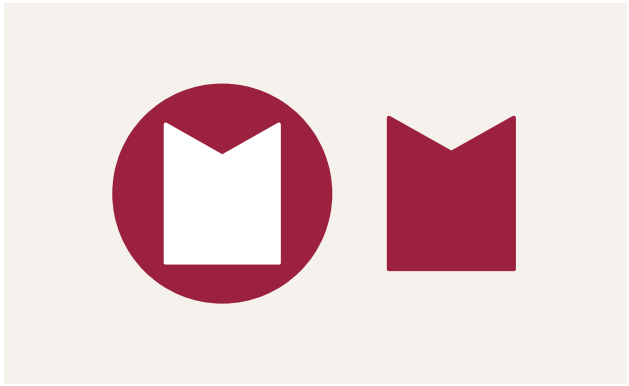
Bilingual · calls, posters, certificates, signage



Bilingual, reversed



Stacked · square spaces, stickers, merchandise



The avatar (white Bookmark on crimson) and the symbol alone: favicons, stamps, badges

Built in. In every lockup the symbol stands as tall as the English wordmark, from the first cap line to the last baseline, and the gap between them equals the depth of the notch. Never assemble a lockup by hand.

CLEAR SPACE AND MISUSE

Clear space *and misuse*



Clear space: one notch depth (about a quarter of the symbol's width) on every side.

Minimum sizes

Bookmark: 16 px on screen, 5 mm printed

Horizontal lockup: 45 mm wide in print; 40 px tall on screen

Wordmark: 9 px cap height; below that, the Bookmark alone

Hudhud: 48 px; his avatar 28 px

With the University

Where the AUIB logo appears it leads; the Society's lockup follows at equal or smaller height.

Inside AUIB's own templates, follow AUIB.

NEVER



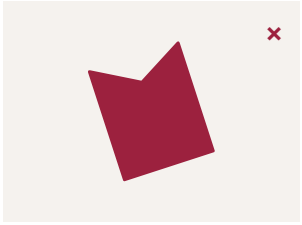
Stretch or squash it



Recolor it



Put the crimson symbol on ink



Rotate it



Add shadows or effects



Retype the name



Repeat it: once per page



Use the light file on crimson

COLOR

Six colors, *one* of them loud

The AUIB three lead: crimson, ink and white. White does most of the work, ink carries the words, and crimson appears once or twice a page at full strength.

White
#FFFFFF
The page for everything.

Ink
#273236
Text, footers, dark mode. 13.2:1 on white.

Crimson
#9C213E
The Bookmark, one word, one button, one band. 7.8:1.

Paper
#F5F2EE
Qirtas and long reading only.

Stone
#E2DDD6
Hairline rules. Never text.

Ash
#5C6568
Secondary text and captions. 6.0:1.



ABOUT 70 WHITE · 18 INK · 7 CRIMSON · 5 PAPER AND STONE

RESERVED

Crimson-700
#7E1A32
Inside the logo files only.

Crimson-100 (rose)
#EBCBD3
Accent on ink; reversed wordmarks.

Mist
#C3CACB
Secondary text in dark mode.

Slate
#3D494D
Rules in dark mode.

Never add a color, and no program may add one. Never use crimson as a pale tint or a large block of headline.

Never set crimson text or the crimson symbol on ink (1.7:1): on ink, the accent is rose.

Retired from v4: crimson-50 and every pink card, ink-70, ink-50, and the “rule” gray.

COLOR ROLES

Color *roles*

Build with roles, not raw colors. Each role has a value for light mode and for dark mode, so one template works in both.

ROLE	LIGHT	DARK	USE
`surface`	white	ink	Page ground
`surface-reading`	paper	ink	Qirtas pages, long reading
`text`	ink	white	Headlines and body
`text-secondary`	ash	mist	Captions, meta, labels
`accent`	crimson	crimson-100	The one loud thing: italic word, button, Bookmark
`on-accent`	white	ink	Text on the accent button
`line`	stone	slate	Hairline rules
`band`	crimson	crimson	One full-bleed band per page at most
`on-band`	white	white	Text on band
`footer`	ink	ink	The footer and the invitation band

Dark mode

Dark mode is ink, for the whole page, on screens only. The visitor's system setting picks it until they choose. Certificates, letters and printouts stay white sheets, and pages print in light mode.

Contrast

Every text pair reaches 4.5:1 in both modes. Rules and fills that carry no words may go lower.

PAIR	RATIO
Ink on white	13.2:1
Ink on paper	11.8:1
Crimson on white	7.8:1
Crimson on paper	7.0:1
Ash on white	6.0:1
Ash on paper	5.3:1
White on crimson	7.8:1
Rose on crimson	5.2:1
Rose on ink	8.8:1
Mist on ink	7.9:1
Crimson on ink	1.7:1 · never

TYPE

Ubuntu, *set like a book*

Ubuntu speaks for the Society in English and Ubuntu Arabic in Arabic: one family for both languages, as AUIB uses it. What changes is the range: Light for display, Regular for reading, Medium for labels.

UBUNTU LIGHT · DISPLAY

Come *in.*

UBUNTU ARABIC · REGULAR

تفضّلوا

STYLE	SCREEN	PRINT (A4)	POST (1080)	WEIGHT	USE
Display	124 · 72 px	58 pt	160 px	Light	Titles, the motto, large dates; one italic accent word
Title	44 px	—	—	Regular	Section titles beside the Bookmark
Heading	28 px	18 pt	—	Regular	List items, card titles
Lede	21 px	17 pt	38 px	Regular	One sentence under a title
Body	17 px	10.5 pt	—	Regular	1.6 leading, 60–70 characters a line
Label	12 px	7.8 pt	28 px	Medium	Small tracked capitals; never sentences, never Arabic
Code	12 px	9 pt	—	Mono	`SAL-GOV-01 · F-14`; six-word typewriter lines

Arabic

Ubuntu Arabic Regular, one step larger than the English beside it, 1.6–2.0 leading. Never tracked or set in capitals; it has no case. `dir="rtl"` and `lang="ar"`.

Inside Qirtas

Long articles in Qirtas are set in Literata for reading. Its masthead, headlines and interface stay Ubuntu.

Bold

For the logo and for emphasis inside a sentence. Never for headlines. Ubuntu Arabic has no Light: Arabic display uses Regular.

Ubuntu, Ubuntu Mono and Literata are free from Google Fonts. Ubuntu Arabic ships with the design system. Never substitute another Arabic face.

SPACE AND SHAPE

Space *and shape*

Space is the main material. Things are separated by margins and hairlines, never by boxes, shadows or fills.

TOKEN	VALUE	
space-1	4 px	
space-2	8 px	
space-3	16 px	
space-4	24 px	
space-5	40 px	
space-6	56 px	
space-7	88 px	
space-8	110 px	
space-9	128 px	
page-margin	21 mm	A4 side margins (79 px)

Corners are square everywhere (`radius-none`). Only avatars are round.

Hairlines (1 px) in `line` between list rows; in `text` under mastheads and section rules.

No shadows and no frames. The v5 offset block is retired.

Lists over cards. Use a card only for a separate object, such as a ticket.

One band of full-bleed color per page at most.

BEFORE

Connecting students

v5: tinted card, frame and offset block

AFTER

Connecting students

Fostering creativity

v6: a list with hairlines

Join the Society

What's on

One solid button; everything else a text link

SCREENS

Screens

auibsal.org and the Nexus share one frame. Same sections and content as before; fewer boxes, bigger words, more air.



Header: one line. The horizontal lockup, five sections at most, العربية, the theme toggle and Sign in as text links. A hairline below.

Front door: the motto in English and Arabic, one sentence, one button.

Events: a dated list, large Light day numbers down the margin, like an almanac.

Qirtas on paper, with a masthead and no empty image spaces.

"Come in." One ink band with the invitation, in both languages, then the ink footer: three short columns.

Phones: nothing scrolls sideways at 360 px. Errors say what happened and what to do; no exclamation marks.

PROGRAMS

The family *of programs*

An endorsed family. Each program may have its own name and title treatment; all of them share the Society's colors and type and carry the endorsement line.

THE PAPER

Qirtas قرطاس

"AUIB's paper of news, letters and art." A masthead in Ubuntu Medium with the Arabic beneath; articles in Literata on paper. Replaces Waraq and "AUIB Literary Journal".

a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE SERIES

Side Quest

A title card and stop-motion; the Bookmark in the end credits. Working title until chosen.

a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE CHARITY DRIVE

Second Chapter

The name with the partner's name beside it, Natrok Athar (نترك اثر); the Bookmark on every poster.

a Society of Arts and Letters programme

THE POP-UP

Typewriter Tour

Ubuntu Mono for the six-word lines; the Bookmark as a stamp on every page.

a Society of Arts and Letters programme

Every program must

- Use the six colors and the Ubuntu family. Never add a color.
- Carry the Bookmark and "a Society of Arts and Letters programme" («من برامج جمعية الفنون والآداب»).
- Tag @auibsal on every post.

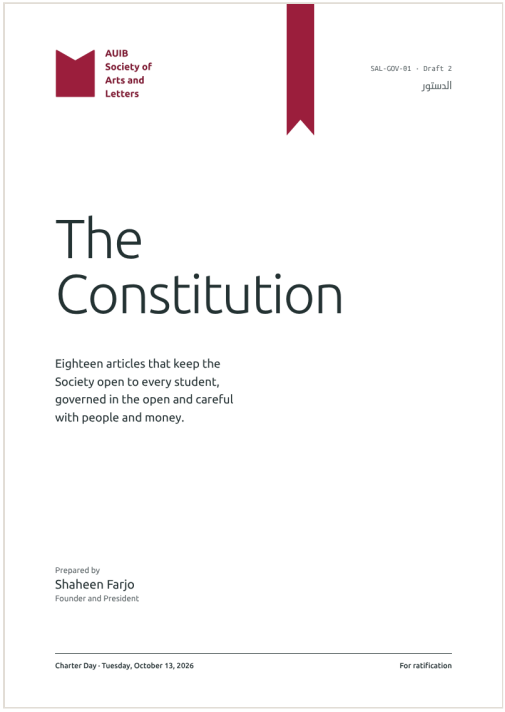
A program may

- Have its own name treatment, approved by the Media Director.
- Use its own handle once it has a year of content.
- Use paper, Ubuntu Mono or Literata as its accent.

DOCUMENTS

Documents

Every Society document is built from the same parts, so a new member can make one that looks like ours on the first try. Documents move to the v6 cover at their next version.



The v6 cover

Cover: lockup top left; the code in Ubuntu Mono and the Arabic title top right; a crimson Bookmark ribbon from the top edge; title in Light, ink; one sentence; “Prepared by”; a hairline footer with the date and status. Always light.

Contents: numbered rows with hairlines; no band.

Section pages: the Bookmark, a one- or two-word Light title, one sentence, then content.

Legal text: two columns; articles numbered in Ubuntu Mono; clause numbers in the margin.

Forms: code and Light title above an ink hairline; the symbol top right; small tracked labels; ink write-on lines that survive photocopying; an office-use strip on paper.

Footers: every page but the cover; a hairline, code and title at left, “3 / 14” at right (spaced slash, no “Page”).

Closing page: “Thank you.” in Light, with the Bookmark.

CODE	SERIES	EXAMPLES
SAL-GOV	Governance	Constitution, Bylaws, Roles and Staffing
SAL-POL	Policies	Policy Manual
SAL-OPS	Operations	Playbook, Templates and Forms
SAL-STR · MEM · BRD · PRT · PRP	Strategy, members, brand, print, proposals	Strategic Plan, Member Handbook, this guide

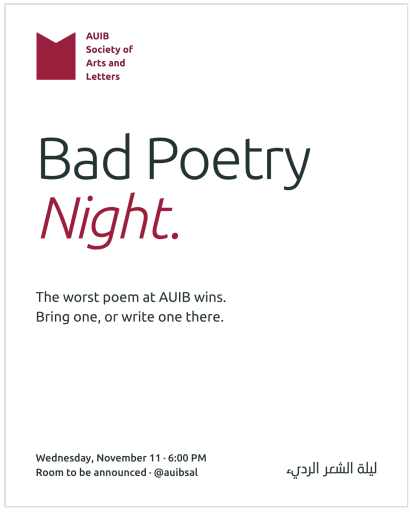
SOCIAL AND PRINT

Social *and print*

One idea per post; the headline does the work. Three grounds, chosen by purpose.



Crimson · calls and moments



White · events (sample date)



Ink · words worth keeping, recruiting

Posts (1080 × 1350)

The horizontal lockup at top left.

Two or three words with a full stop in Light, one italic word at most.

One sentence; the date, place and @auibsal at bottom left; one line of Arabic at bottom right.

Every post has the date. Profile pictures use sal-avatar.svg.

Print

Posters A3/A4: lockup, Light headline, a QR code at bottom right.

Term Card: A6, four to an A4 sheet. Membership cards: 85 × 55 mm.

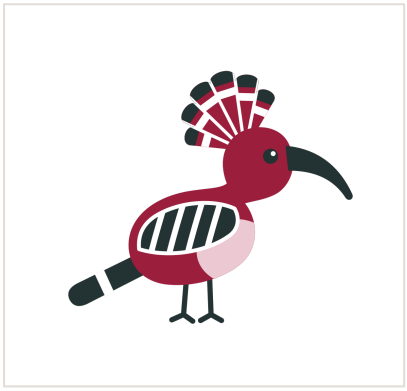
Certificates: A4 landscape, one hairline frame and the Bookmark.

Reprint only when current stock runs out.

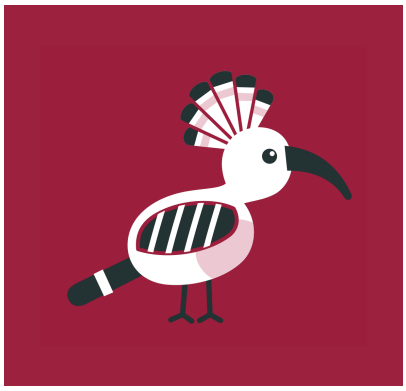
THE MASCOT

Hudhud هدهد

A hoopoe: native to Iraq, the messenger of the old stories, and the guide in Attar's *The Conference of the Birds*. He is the face of the Telegram bot and appears only where the Society talks to members one to one.









Twelve Telegram stickers, 512 × 512, with a white die-cut edge

Drawn flat in the brand's colors with no outlines: crimson body, rose breast, ink wings, tail and beak with white bars.

Hudhud and the logo never touch: no symbol or letter anywhere on him, and he never stands in for the logo.

Props and expressions belong to the stickers only.

Avatars: the white Bookmark on crimson for the Society's accounts; white Hudhud on crimson for the bot only.

He speaks in the first person, warm and brief: "You're in. I'll remind you before it starts." No exclamation marks, no emoji.

48 px and up; his avatar works down to 28 px.

VOICE

Voice

We sound like a well-read friend: warm, precise and never grand.

WE ARE	WE ARE NOT	SO WE WRITE
Warm	Gushing	“We would love you to join us.” Not “An AMAZING opportunity!!!”
Concrete	Vague	“Tuesday, October 13, 4 PM, Room [x].” Not “soon, somewhere on campus.”
Confident	Grand	“A paper read blind and printed with care.” Not “Iraq’s premier literary institution.”
Bilingual	Translated as an afterthought	Arabic written for Arabic readers, then checked by a native speaker.
Playful	Mocking	“The worst poem at AUIB wins.” Jokes about ideas, never people.

House style

Short titles: “Charter Day”, “Every Dinar”, “The Ribbon”.

Dates as “Tuesday, October 13”; times as “6:00 PM”; money as “50,000 IQD”.

Numerals in tables; words in prose under ten.

American English everywhere: organization, program, color. Quoted adopted text and the endorsement line keep their own spelling.

No emoji; no exclamation marks in headlines.

Names and pictures

“AUIB Society of Arts and Letters” in full on first use; then “the Society” or “SAL”. Never “the club”, never “Art and Letter”.

The paper is Qirtas (قرطاس). Side Quest stays a working title until chosen.

Arabic-named partners in their own language first: Natrok Athar (نترك اثر).

No icon set. The Bookmark is our picture, and Hudhud in one-to-one channels; use words, not icons or emoji. Mark wrong examples with a plain “×”.

PHOTOGRAPHY

Photography

Our own photos of our own people, taken with consent, always beat stock images.

Shoot

- Hands on typewriter keys, pages, books being handed over
- Readers mid-sentence; full rooms
- Close-ups only with consent
- Natural light; no heavy filters

Never shoot

- Anyone wearing a camera-shy sticker
- Identifiable children, ever
- People praying, in distress or in private moments
- Stock photos of books or typewriters in place of ours

Treat

- Color natural and slightly warm
- Duotone in crimson or ink for posters and covers
- Crop with room for a headline
- No photo means a typographic layout: never an empty image box

Keep

- Every event archived within a week in 05 Media
- Consent log updated with every release (F-17)
- Two copies: the Drive and one offline backup

RETIRED

Retired

Do not use these on anything new. Existing printed stock may be used up; every new piece follows version 6.



The round Key · v3, September 28 to October 4, 2026



v5 frames and offset blocks, tracked-capital buttons, pink cards



The name Waraq and “AUIB Literary Journal”: now Qirtas

Bold crimson headlines on screens, posts and covers: headlines are Light, in ink.

Retired tokens: `crimson-50`, `ink-70`, `ink-50`, `rule`, `surface-tint`, `text-meta`, `title`, `accent-line`, `frame`, `offset`, `radius-card`, `radius-key`.

The crimson footer band on covers and the Contents band: a hairline footer and a Bookmark ribbon.

Noto Kufi Arabic (v3): Ubuntu Arabic only.

Still carrying the Key: the September 28 founding documents and four Instagram posts. Update them to v6 before they are printed or posted again.

FILES AND TEMPLATES

Files *and templates*

Everything lives in the Society's design system, "AUIB Society of Arts and Letters", and in the platform's brand folder, with copies in SAL Drive › 05 Media › Brand.

FILE	WHAT IT IS
`sal-lockup-horizontal(-reversed).svg`	Symbol + English; the default
`sal-lockup-bilingual(-reversed).svg`	English | symbol | Arabic; anything public
`sal-lockup-stacked(-reversed).svg`	Symbol over English; stickers, merchandise
`sal-symbol.svg · sal-symbol-white.svg`	The Bookmark alone
`sal-wordmark-en / -ar (-reversed).svg`	The wordmarks
`sal-avatar.svg`	White Bookmark on crimson; profile pictures
`hudhud*.svg / .png · stickers`	Hudhud, his avatar and twelve stickers
`UbuntuArabic-Regular / -Bold.woff2`	Arabic typeface, shipped with the system
`tokens.json · bundle.css`	Colors, type, space and the components: cover, footer, form, post

Fonts. Ubuntu, Ubuntu Mono and Literata are free from Google Fonts. Ubuntu Arabic is not on Google Fonts: install it from the design system's fonts folder. Install them before editing any template. In Canva, upload the logo SVGs and Ubuntu Arabic to the Brand Kit with the six colors.

DOCUMENT	VERSION	OWNER	APPROVED BY
SAL-BRD-01	6.0 (draft 1)	Media Director	Council

Version history: 3.0 September 28, 2026 · 4.0 October 4, 2026 · v5 Screens amendment October 8, 2026 · 6.0 October 24, 2026. Next review each September. The current version always lives in SAL Drive › 01 Governance; printed copies may be out of date.

SAL-BRD-01

Thank *you.*

شكرا